



Search

[MORE](#)["She knew what she'd created": Back to Black](#)[Trower's '80s supergroup](#)[Tutorials](#) > [Music Production Tutorials](#)

How to create a tearing neurofunk DnB Reese sound in Xfer Records Serum

Tuition By [Future Music](#) | Published 27 June 2017

Modern synths such as Xfer Serum make it easy to synthesise complex growls and morphing timbres in the style of Noisia...



Share

Newsletter

Xfer Records' Serum is without doubt one of the most powerful, sonically impressive soft synths to date, thanks to its versatile wavetable architecture, stunning filter, wild modulation and knock-out effects.

The ability to modulate wavetable position and Warp make Serum a monster synth for drum 'n' bass, with an incredible amount of moment-to-moment variation brought to bear via only the most rudimentary of parameter tweaks.

In this tutorial, we'll walk you through the programming of a Reese-style patch fit to get heads nodding.

Latest Videos From MusicRadar

For more power synth tutorials, pick up the [May edition of Future Music](#).



Step 1: Call up Xfer Records Serum, load the [Bs Reese Evolve](#)

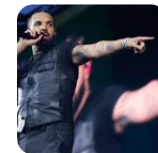
[preset](#), then trigger the synth by playing notes on your MIDI keyboard. This thick, evolving Reese bass sounds complex but is actually pretty straightforward in programming terms. Let's delve deeper into the patch...

YOU MAY LIKE

[How to replicate the sample-based sonics of a gnarly Prodigy classic](#)



[How to re-create Drake's smooth Burning Bridges sound using plugins](#)



[How to recreate the '90s-channelling energy of a PinkPantheress banger](#)



Step 2: The synth's Mono and Legato are on, and Portamento is at around 12 o'clock, giving us a bending, gliding effect. The patch's core movement is created via LFO 1's slow, unsync'd modulation of Osc A's WT Pos knob, which is scanning through Osc A's gnarly wavetable.



Step 3: Old-school DnB ‘wobble’ basses often have a distinctive change in speed when played up and down the keyboard. To replicate this, Osc B (a sine) is modulating Osc A’s amplitude via Osc A’s Warp mode, set to AM (from B). A slow-attack envelope increases this Warp amount over the course of each note.

Get the MusicRadar Newsletter

Want all the hottest music and gear news, reviews, deals, features and more, direct to your inbox? Sign up here.

SIGN ME UP

- ☐ Contact me with news and offers from other Future brands
- ☐ Receive email from us on behalf of our trusted partners or sponsors

By submitting your information you agree to the [Terms & Conditions](#) and [Privacy Policy](#) and are aged 16 or over.



Step 4: Head over to Serum's FX tab, and you'll see that the insert effects we've dialed in are huge contributors to the bass's aggression and character. Heavy compression is placed after reverb, causing it to swell out between notes. There's also forceful distortion, careful EQ and widening going on.



Step 5: Back to the Osc panel. For fizz, Serum's Noise oscillator is pushing additional high-frequency noise into the final distortion stage; and the sub oscillator is adding solid low-end to the overall sound. Finally, note the filter: we're modulating a double notch type for even more sweeping motion.



Step 6: LFO 1's Mode is set to Off, so our wavetable modulation is constantly evolving. This means that each bass note has different modulation. Therefore, for more consistency, it's a good idea to print a good few minutes of a programmed riff as audio, then chop out the very best takes.



[Future Music](#)

Future Music is the number one magazine for today's producers. Packed with technique and technology we'll help you make great new music. All-access artist interviews, in-depth gear reviews, essential production tutorials and much more. Every marvellous monthly edition features reliable reviews of the latest and greatest hardware and software technology and techniques, unparalleled advice, in-depth interviews, sensational free samples and so much more to improve the experience and outcome of your music-making.

[READ MORE](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to replicate the sample-based sonics of a gnarly Prodigy classic](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to re-create Drake's smooth Burning Bridges sound using plugins](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to recreate the '90s-channelling energy of a PinkPantheress banger](#) __



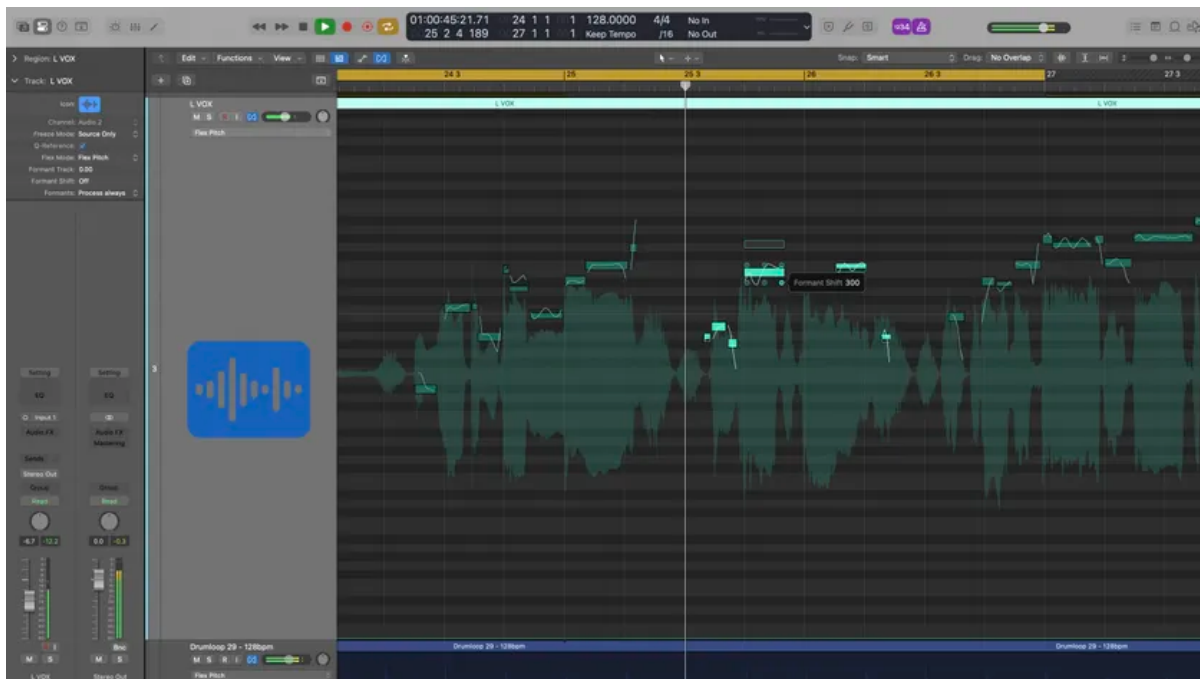
[Artists](#)

[How to emulate one of Jon Hopkins' signature sonic techniques with plugins](#) __



[Music Production Tutorials](#)

[How to use reverb to build impressive-sounding filters, reverses, risers and pads](#)



[Plugins](#)

[How to get recognisable pop sounds and effects using only Logic's stock plugins](#)

LATEST IN MUSIC PRODUCTION TUTORIALS



[Music Production Tutorials](#)

[How to use a mixing console](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to replicate Charli XCX's sonic characteristics](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to re-create Drake's smooth Burning Bridges sound using plugins](#)



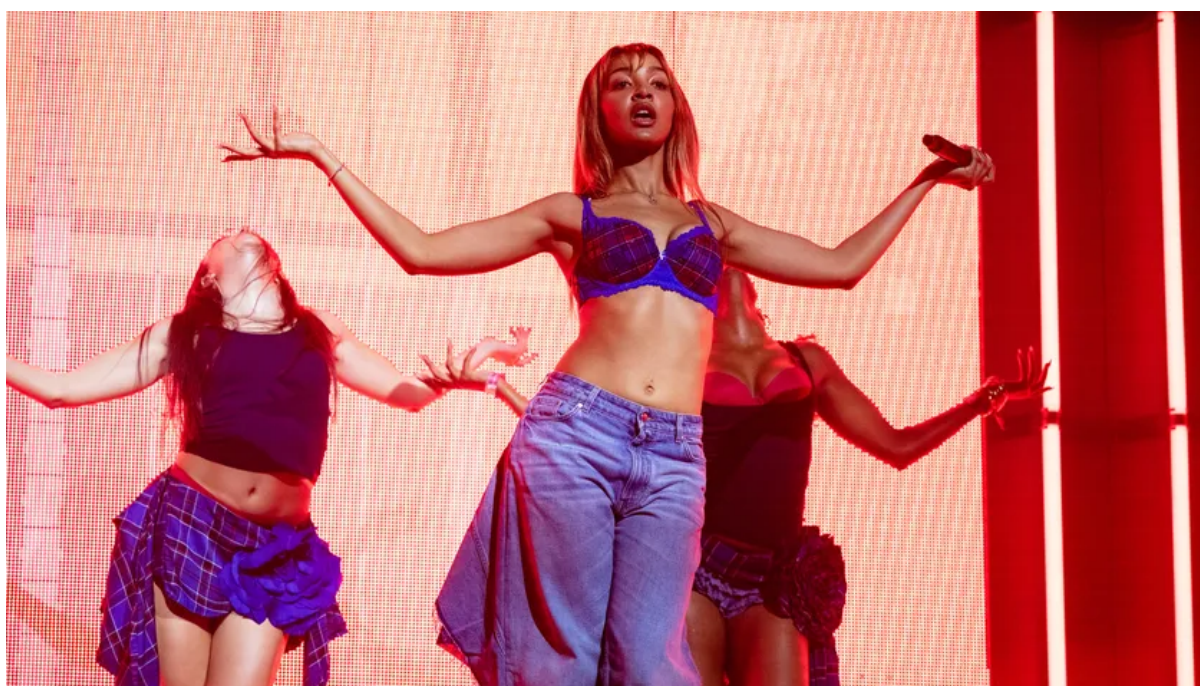
[Artists](#)

[How to get Radiohead's resonant National Anthem vocal effect in software](#)



[Music Production Tutorials](#)

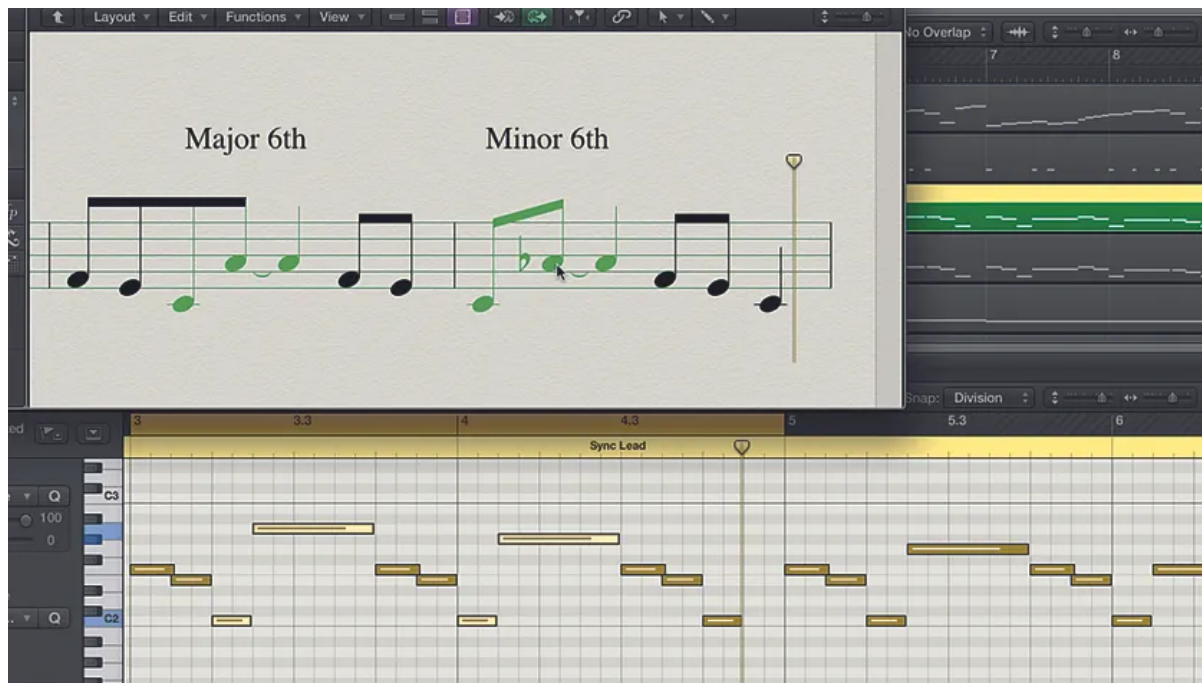
[Build your own expressive talkbox with plugins](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to recreate the '90s-channelling energy of a PinkPantheress banger](#)

LATEST IN TUITION



[Music Theory And Songwriting](#)

[10 music theory tricks every producer and songwriter should know](#)



[Keyboards & Pianos](#)

[Here's everything you need to know about keyboard sizes but were afraid to ask](#)



[Music Production Tutorials](#)

[How to use a mixing console](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to get Radiohead's resonant National Anthem vocal effect in software](#)



[Music Production Tutorials](#)

[Build your own expressive talkbox with plugins](#)



[Artists](#)

[How to emulate one of Jon Hopkins' signature sonic techniques with plugins](#)

MusicRadar is part of Future plc, an international media group and leading digital publisher. [Visit our corporate site.](#)



[About Us](#)

[Contact Future's experts](#)

[Terms and conditions](#)

[Privacy policy](#)

[Cookies policy](#)

[Advertise with us](#)

[Accessibility Statement](#)

[Careers](#)

© Future Publishing Limited Quay House, The Ambury, Bath BA1 1UA. All rights reserved. England and Wales company registration number 2008885.